

4. PROJECT PLANNING PHASE

Project: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Platform: ServiceNow – Flow Designer and Service Catalog

Introduction

Project Planning is an important phase that defines the activities, milestones, resources, and sequence of tasks required to complete the project successfully. In this project, the planning focuses on automating the Standard Laptop ordering process using ServiceNow Flow Designer and Service Catalog. The project is planned through three major milestones: creating the Flow, assigning the Flow to the Standard Laptop catalog item, and placing and processing the Standard Laptop order. This structured planning helps ensure that each activity is completed in the proper sequence.

Planning Overview

The project is planned as a sequence of milestones that moves from flow creation to flow assignment and finally to the Service Catalog request process. The project document describes three milestones: Flow, Flow Assignment, and Service Catalog.

Project Milestones

Milestone	Activity	Expected Result
Milestone 1	Create the “Standard Laptop Task” Flow using Flow Designer. Configure the Service Catalog trigger and Create Catalog Task action.	The Flow is created, configured, saved, and activated.
Milestone 2	Assign the created Flow to the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item through Maintain Items.	The Standard Laptop item is connected with the automated Flow.
Milestone 3	Place the Standard Laptop order through Service Catalog and process the request. T	he request is approved and the required Catalog Task is generated for the Hardware group.

Project Planning Diagram

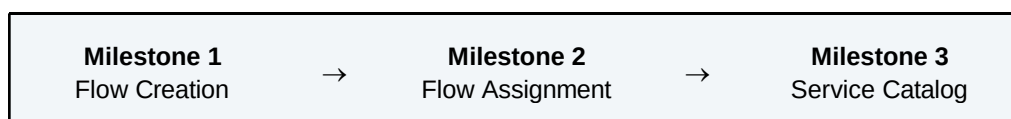
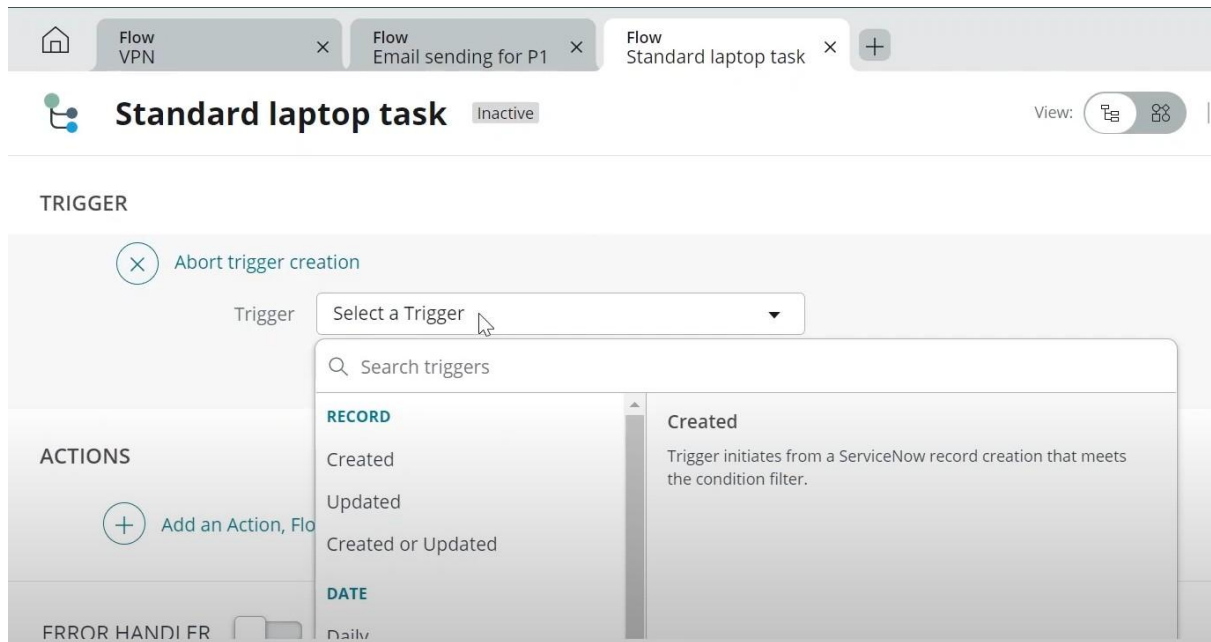


Figure 1: Milestone-based project planning sequence

Activity Planning

Activity	Planned Work
Flow Creation	Create the “Standard Laptop Task” Flow using the Global application and System user.
Trigger Configuration	Add a Service Catalog trigger to start the Flow when a Standard Laptop request is processed.
Task Automation	Add the Create Catalog Task action and configure the Requested Item Record, short description, description, Assignment Group, and Approval.
Flow Assignment	Open Maintain Items, select Standard Laptop, remove the remaining automations, and add the created Flow.
Service Catalog Ordering	Open Service Catalog, select Standard Laptop, and place the order.
Request Verification	Approve the request and verify the generated Catalog Task and its assigned Hardware group.

ServiceNow Flow Designer – Standard Laptop Task Flow



Resource and Responsibility Planning

The planned workflow uses ServiceNow Flow Designer for automation and assigns the generated Catalog Task to the Hardware group. The project document specifies the Hardware assignment group for laptop configuration.

Planned Outcome

The planned sequence results in an automated Standard Laptop procurement workflow: the service request starts the flow, the flow creates the Catalog Task, and the task is routed to the Hardware team for configuration.

Conclusion

The Project Planning Phase provides a clear roadmap for implementing the Standard Laptop automation workflow. By dividing the project into milestones and planned activities, the Flow creation, Flow assignment, and Service Catalog ordering processes can be carried out systematically. This planning supports the successful implementation of the automated procurement process and helps achieve the intended project outcome.